



Claude Certifications

The complete field guide to the four Anthropic Claude certifications: what each exam measures, what it costs, how to prepare for it, and how to sit it.

Associate Foundations

Developer Foundations

Architect Foundations

Architect Professional



Compiled by Amey Thakur

Written while preparing for these exams, after working through every course in the official curriculum.
github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS · amey-thakur.github.io/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS

Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guides and program pages. A community study resource, not affiliated with or endorsed by Anthropic. Free to share.

Why this booklet exists

I sat down to prepare for these certifications and found the material scattered: the blueprint in one PDF, the policies in another, the courses on a platform behind a sign-in, the registration mechanics somewhere else again, and the practical details, the ones that actually cost people a sitting, written down nowhere at all.

So I collected it. Every official exam guide, every policy, every course, the blueprints with their real weights, and the things I only learned by going through it: which domains carry the marks, which options an exam question is quietly steering you away from, and how much of a failed attempt is logistics rather than knowledge.

None of this required anything you do not already have. The official material is free, the blueprints tell you exactly what is tested, and the rest is steady work.

What I could not do is give you the questions, and I would not if I could. Every candidate signs a non-disclosure agreement, and a credential is only worth holding if the people holding it earned it. So everything here is built from published material: the official blueprints, the published scenarios, and practice written from scratch against them.

Read the roadmap, pick the exam that matches the work you already do, and work its page. Keep the cheat sheet for the day before. If a fact here disagrees with the official exam guide, believe the guide, and please tell me so I can fix it.

I put this in one place so your time goes into learning rather than looking. If it helps you get certified, it did its job. Good luck.

— Amey Thakur



What is in this booklet

Everything a candidate needs, in the order they need it. The repository holds the living version, including a practice engine and the mirrored official documents.

Choosing your exam	Which certification matches the work you do, and what each measures
The roadmap	All four certifications, their domain weights, and the courses that prepare for each
One page per certification	Exam facts, where the marks are, and the rules that decide questions
The official curriculum	Every Anthropic course and the exam it serves
Preparing	A study plan that fits a job, and how to practise without breaking the exam agreement
Registration and exam day	Booking, proctoring setup, and the checklist worth keeping
Policies and scoring	Retakes, validity, renewal, appeals, and how the score is built
The repository behind it	What the living version does that paper cannot

How to use it. Read the roadmap, pick your exam, then work its page. Keep the cheat sheet for the day before. Everything here is derived from the official exam guides, which remain the authoritative source and are mirrored in the repository.



Which certification is yours?

Pick the exam that matches the work you already do. There are no prerequisites in either direction.



START HERE

Which certification is yours?

Pick the exam that matches the work you already do. There are no prerequisites, and each credential lasts 12 months.

You advise customers and run engagements

Associate · Foundations

CCAO-F · 60 items · \$99

Does not count toward partner tier

- Turning business problems into Claude workflows
- Judging output quality and knowing when to escalate
- Data sensitivity and responsible use

You build with the API, Claude Code, or MCP

Developer · Foundations

CCDV-F · 53 items · \$125

Counts toward partner tier

- API mechanics: messages, streaming, batches, caching
- Agents, tools, MCP servers, and structured output
- Security, cost control, and evaluation

You design Claude solutions end to end

Architect · Foundations

CCAR-F · 60 items · \$125

Counts toward partner tier

- Agentic architecture and orchestration
- Claude Code configuration for teams and CI
- Four of six published scenarios appear on your paper

You govern Claude systems at enterprise scale

Architect · Professional

CCAR-P · 63 items · \$175

No prerequisite. Foundations does not upgrade into it

- Integration, retrieval, and observability at scale
- Evaluation frameworks and governance
- Communicating architecture to stakeholders

Every exam: 120 minutes, closed book, proctored by Pearson VUE, passing at 720 of 1000, valid 12 months with a free renewal assessment.



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github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS

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Choosing your exam

The roadmap

All four certifications side by side: what each measures, what it costs, and what prepares you for it.



Claude Certification Roadmap

Four certifications, three roles. What each exam covers, what it costs, and what prepares you for it.

ASSOCIATE

Foundations

CCAO-F · 60 items · \$99
120 min · pass 720/1000

Consultants, sellers, and delivery leads

DOMAINS BY WEIGHT

Output evaluation	21%
Workflow integration	16%
Governance and risk	15%
Prompting	14%
Product and model choice	12%
Configuration	12%
Troubleshooting	10%

PREPARE WITH

Claude 101
Claude Platform 101
AI Fluency: Framework
AI Capabilities and Limits
Introduction to Cowork

Does not count toward partner tier

DEVELOPER

Foundations

CCDV-F · 53 items · \$125
120 min · pass 720/1000

Engineers building on the Claude platform

DOMAINS BY WEIGHT

Applications and integration	33%
Model selection and cost	17%
Agents and workflows	15%
Prompt and context	11%
Tools and MCP	11%
Security and safety	8%
Claude Code, eval	6%

PREPARE WITH

Building with the Claude API
Introduction to MCP
Claude Code in Action
Introduction to agent skills
Introduction to subagents

Counts toward partner tier

ARCHITECT

Foundations

CCAR-F · 60 items · \$125
120 min · 4 of 6 scenarios

Architects building production systems

DOMAINS BY WEIGHT

Agentic architecture	27%
Claude Code workflows	20%
Prompting, structured output	20%
Tool design and MCP	18%
Context and reliability	15%

PREPARE WITH

Claude Code in Action
Introduction to MCP
Building with the Claude API
Agent skills and subagents
The six published scenarios

Counts toward partner tier

ARCHITECT

Professional

CCAR-P · 63 items · \$175
120 min · pass 720/1000

Architects governing systems at scale

DOMAINS BY WEIGHT

Integration	19%
Solution design	17%
Evaluation and testing	16%
Governance and risk	14%
Stakeholders, lifecycle	14%
Models and prompting	13%
Developer enablement	7%

PREPARE WITH

MCP: Advanced Topics
Claude with Amazon Bedrock
Claude on Google Cloud
An end-to-end system you built
Anthropic engineering articles

No prerequisite. Foundations does not upgrade

Every exam: 120 minutes · closed book · Pearson VUE, online or test centre · pass at 720 of 1000 · valid 12 months, free renewal · badge via Credly · partner tiers get 50% off



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The roadmap

ASSOCIATE · FOUNDATIONS

Claude Certified Associate

CCAO-F

exam code

60

items

120

minutes

720

to pass

\$99

list fee

12

months valid

WHERE THE MARKS ARE

Output evaluation	21%
Workflow integration	16%
Governance and risk	15%
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Product and model choice	12%
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Troubleshooting	10%

WHO IT IS FOR

Consultants, sellers, and delivery leads. Does not count toward partner tier.

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

1. Verify anything specific and consequential. Confidence is not evidence.
2. Omission fails too. Read the source, not only the output.
3. Anonymize, then analyze. Instructions are not a control.
4. Match the model to the task in both directions.
5. Structure beats intensifiers: role, sections, constraints, example.
6. Projects hold what repeats; prompts hold what changes.
7. Project knowledge is maintained by you, not self-updating.
8. Diagnose what changed before rewriting anything.
9. Escalate system integrations to Developer and Architect scope.

PREPARE WITH

Claude 101 · Claude Platform 101 · AI Fluency: Framework · AI Capabilities and Limits · Introduction to Cowork



Cheat sheet: Associate Foundations

The page worth keeping for the hour before the exam.

ASSOCIATE · FOUNDATIONS · CHEAT SHEET Claude Certified Associate

CCAO-F

exam code

60

items

120

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ON THE DAY

Answer everything, unanswered scores zero · flag and return rather than stalling · read how many responses each item wants · find the stated constraint, then eliminate

Full sheet, study guide, notes, practice questions, and a timed mock exam: amey-thakur.github.io/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS



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Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guide



Claude Certified Developer

CCDV-F

exam code

53

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WHERE THE MARKS ARE

Applications and integration	33%
Model selection and cost	17%
Agents and workflows	15%
Prompt and context	11%
Tools and MCP	11%
Security and safety	8%
Claude Code, eval	6%

WHO IT IS FOR

Engineers building on the Claude platform. Counts toward partner tier.

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

1. stop_reason drives the loop: tool_use executes, end_turn finishes.
2. Batches for latency-tolerant volume: half cost, 24-hour window.
3. Stable prefix first, then cache it. Cuts latency and cost together.
4. Enforce a schema, validate, retry with the validation error.
5. Known path is a workflow. Unknown path earns an agent.
6. Subagents exist to isolate context, not to add horsepower.
7. Pin model versions; upgrades become evaluated changes.
8. Injection is defeated structurally, never by asking politely.
9. A tool the agent does not hold cannot be misused.

PREPARE WITH

Building with the Claude API · Introduction to MCP · Claude Code in Action · Introduction to agent skills · Introduction to subagents



Cheat sheet: Developer Foundations

The page worth keeping for the hour before the exam.

DEVELOPER · FOUNDATIONS · CHEAT SHEET Claude Certified Developer

CCDV-F

exam code

53

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Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guide



Claude Certified Architect

CCAR-F

exam code

60

items

120

minutes

720

to pass

\$125

list fee

12

months valid

WHERE THE MARKS ARE

Agentic architecture	27%
Claude Code workflows	20%
Prompting, structured output	20%
Tool design and MCP	18%
Context and reliability	15%

WHO IT IS FOR

Architects building production systems. Counts toward partner tier.

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

1. Agent loops need engineered termination, not a token budget.
2. Escalate on policy gaps and lack of progress.
3. Structured errors: a category and a retryable flag.
4. Tool descriptions are the selection mechanism. Differentiate them.
5. Hard limits belong in the tool layer, never in a prompt.
6. CLAUDE.md hierarchy, with path-scoped rules for conditional context.
7. CI means headless: print mode, JSON output, a schema.
8. Subagents return findings; raw documents stay at the edge.
9. Provenance must survive every handoff.

PREPARE WITH

Claude Code in Action · Introduction to MCP · Building with the Claude API · Agent skills and subagents · The six published scenarios



Cheat sheet: Architect Foundations

The page worth keeping for the hour before the exam.

ARCHITECT · FOUNDATIONS · CHEAT SHEET Claude Certified Architect

CCAR-F

exam code

60

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list fee

12

months valid

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Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guide



Claude Certified Architect

CCAR-P

exam code

63

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to pass

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WHERE THE MARKS ARE

Integration	19%
Solution design	17%
Evaluation and testing	16%
Governance and risk	14%
Stakeholders, lifecycle	14%
Models and prompting	13%
Developer enablement	7%

WHO IT IS FOR

Architects governing systems at scale. No prerequisite.
Foundations does not upgrade.

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

1. Climb the pattern ladder only when the rung below cannot hold.
2. Least privilege means removal, not monitoring.
3. Retrieval degradation after a data change is an index problem.
4. Subjective quality is measured with rubrics and labeled sets.
5. Prompt changes are production changes: regression, then A/B.
6. Compliance is enforced before data crosses the boundary.
7. Route human review by confidence and consequence.
8. Present segmented, honest numbers, never a flattering average.
9. Observability captures traces, not just outputs.

PREPARE WITH

MCP: Advanced Topics · Claude with Amazon Bedrock · Claude on Google Cloud · An end-to-end system you built · Anthropic engineering articles



Cheat sheet: Architect Professional

The page worth keeping for the hour before the exam.

ARCHITECT · PROFESSIONAL · CHEAT SHEET Claude Certified Architect

CCAR-P

exam code

63

items

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minutes

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Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guide



The six published scenarios

Unique to Architect Foundations: four of these six frame every question on the paper.



ARCHITECT · FOUNDATIONS

The six published exam scenarios

Four of these six frame every question on your paper. Knowing them in advance is the largest preparation advantage on any Claude exam.

1

Customer support resolution agent

Agent SDK with MCP tools: `get_customer`, `lookup_order`, `process_refund`, `escalate_to_human`
Loop termination · escalation triggers · tool scoping · structured errors

2

Code generation with Claude Code

A team using Claude Code for generation, refactoring, debugging, and documentation
CLAUDE.md hierarchy · path-scoped rules · plan mode · custom commands

3

Multi-agent research system

A coordinator delegating to search, analysis, synthesis, and report subagents
Context handoffs · provenance · error propagation · citation integrity

4

Developer productivity tooling

Agents exploring unfamiliar codebases with built-in tools and MCP servers
Read, Write, Bash, Grep, Glob selection · MCP integration · large-context strategy

5

Claude Code in CI/CD

Automated code review, test generation, and pull request feedback
Headless invocation · JSON output · explicit review criteria · false positives

6

Structured data extraction

Extraction from unstructured documents, validated against JSON schemas
Schema design · validation retry loops · batch processing · confidence scoring

Rehearse each scenario until its likely questions are predictable. Every scenario names its primary domains in the official exam guide.



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github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS

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Scenarios published in the official Anthropic exam guide



Amey Thakur · github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS

Architect scenarios

The official curriculum

Every Anthropic course, free on the public Academy, and the exam each one serves.



OFFICIAL CURRICULUM

Every course, and the exam it serves

All of these are free on the public Anthropic Academy. No partner account is needed to learn the material; only the proctored exams require partner membership.

Claude platform

Claude 101	Associate
Claude Platform 101	Associate
Claude Code 101	Developer · Architect
Claude Code in Action	Developer · Architect
Introduction to Claude Cowork	Associate

Developer and integration

Building with the Claude API	Developer · Architect
Introduction to Model Context Protocol	Developer · Architect
Model Context Protocol: Advanced Topics	Architect Professional
Introduction to agent skills	Developer · Architect
Introduction to subagents	Developer · Architect

Deployment platforms

Claude with Amazon Bedrock	Architect
Claude with Google Cloud's Vertex AI	Architect

AI Fluency

AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations	Associate
AI Capabilities and Limitations	Associate
AI Fluency for Builders	Associate
Role editions: educators, pK-12, students, nonprofits, small business	Context
Teaching AI Fluency	Instructors

Per-course notes on what each is worth, what to watch for, and the order worth taking them in are in the repository.



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github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS

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Course catalogue published on Anthropic Academy



A working study plan

Three weeks alongside a job. The shape matters more than the calendar: scope, then depth, then close.



A WORKING PLAN

Three weeks, alongside a full-time job

Compress or stretch it to fit. The shape matters more than the calendar: scope, then depth, then close.

WEEK ONE

Scope

- Read the exam guide end to end
- Turn the blueprint into a red, amber, green checklist
- Work the prep courses for your exam
- Mark items green only when you could explain them

WEEK TWO

Depth

- Attack red items first, weighted by domain percentage
- Build the thing the guide asks you to build
- Read the official documentation for weak areas
- Drill one weak domain a day

WEEK THREE

Close

- Reread the exam guide
- Work the official sample questions and rationales
- Sit a timed mock and study the domain breakdown
- Run the system test on the exam machine

THE TWO RULES THAT MATTER MOST

Study by domain weight, not by what interests you · build something real, because the exams test judgment and judgment comes from hitting the tradeoffs yourself

Book the exam once the checklist is mostly green. Rescheduling is free until 24 hours out, so an early booking costs nothing and sets a deadline.



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Method from the official preparation guidance



Preparing

A METHOD THAT WORKS

1. **Read the exam guide twice.** Once before studying, once after. It states plainly that the blueprint is the authoritative scope: anything outside it is not on the exam.
2. **Turn the blueprint into a checklist.** Mark each objective red, amber, or green, and study red first, weighted by the domain percentages rather than by interest.
3. **Build something real.** Every official guide asks for this. The exams test judgment in scenarios, and judgment comes from having hit the tradeoffs yourself.
4. **Use the official sample questions as calibration.** The rationales matter more than the answers: they show what the exam considers wrong, and why.
5. **Book once the checklist is mostly green.** Rescheduling is free until 24 hours out, so an early booking costs nothing and sets a deadline.

PRACTISING WITHOUT BREAKING THE AGREEMENT

Every candidate accepts a non-disclosure agreement covering exam questions, answer options, and scenarios, and it extends explicitly to online forums. Real exam content must never be shared or sought. There is also no official practice exam: the previous platform's was retired in the move to Pearson.

What works instead, and stays clean: generate your own questions from the published blueprint. The repository ships a bank of original questions with a shuffled, timed engine that runs in the browser or a terminal, and a set of Claude Code commands that quiz, drill, and plan against the blueprints.

The honest framing. Practice questions calibrate your knowledge against the blueprint. They are not exam items, and treating any question set as "the real ones" is both a policy violation and a poor strategy, because the item bank is confidential and rotates.



Exam day

Most failed sittings are logistics, not knowledge.



EXAM DAY

The checklist worth keeping

Most failed sittings are logistics, not knowledge. Work through this the week before, then again on the morning.

A week before

- ☐ Run the OnVUE system test on the exact machine and network
- ☐ Send the required Pearson domains to your IT team
- ☐ Confirm your registration name matches your photo ID exactly
- ☐ Request accommodations if you need them, before scheduling
- ☐ Check your partner discount appears at checkout

The night before

- ☐ Reschedule free of charge only until 24 hours out
- ☐ Clear the desk, unplug the second monitor, book the room
- ☐ Charge the machine and locate your government-issued ID
- ☐ Reread the exam guide blueprint one last time
- ☐ Sleep. The paper rewards judgment, not cramming

On the morning

- ☐ Close browsers, Zoom, Teams, Outlook, Discord, remote access tools
- ☐ Close the Claude desktop app; OnVUE will not launch beside it
- ☐ Rerun the system test, even if it passed last week
- ☐ Start check-in early; it takes longer than you expect
- ☐ Eat something. Seat time is about 135 minutes

During the exam

- ☐ Answer everything: an unanswered item scores zero
- ☐ Flag and move on rather than stalling on one question
- ☐ Read how many responses each multiple-response item wants
- ☐ Find the stated constraint, then eliminate against it
- ☐ Report a faulty question afterwards; it never counts against you

Full registration and proctoring detail, including the complete domain allowlist and application shutdown list, is in the repository.



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Requirements published by Anthropic and Pearson VUE



Scoring and second chances

How the score is built, what a failed attempt actually costs, and how the credential stays alive.



SCORING AND SECOND CHANCES

What happens after you click submit

How the score is built, what a failure actually costs, and how the credential stays alive.

HOW THE SCORE IS BUILT

100 – 1000

scaled range

720

to pass

criterion

referenced, not a curve

per domain

percent correct reported

Scaling equates forms of different difficulty. The domain breakdown does not decide the result, but it is the best study signal you will get.

IF YOU DO NOT PASS

1st attempt

wait 14 days

>

2nd attempt

wait 30 days

>

3rd attempt

wait 90 days

>

4th attempt

cap for 12 months

Every attempt costs the full fee, and your partner discount applies to retakes exactly as to a first sitting. Limits are per exam, so one failure never blocks a different track.

KEEPING IT ALIVE

Renew on time

A free, open-book, non-proctored assessment on Partner Academy, retakable as often as you need. Extends the credential another 12 months.

Let it lapse

The full proctored exam again, at the full fee. There is no partial credit for a credential that expired.

A disputed question never changes a pass or fail on its own: a confirmed faulty item that affected a result is remedied with a free retake.



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Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guides and policies



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Scoring

Policies and scoring

HOW THE SCORE IS BUILT

Each exam is criterion-referenced: you are measured against a fixed standard set by subject matter experts, not against other candidates. Results are reported on a scaled range of 100 to 1,000, with 720 required to pass, and scaling equates forms of slightly different difficulty.

Your score report also shows percent-correct per domain. Those percentages do not decide the result, but they are the most reliable study signal you will get, and they should drive the next plan.

RETAKES

Waiting periods grow with each failed attempt: 14 days after the first, 30 after the second, 90 after the third, with at most four attempts per exam in a rolling 12 months. Each attempt costs the full fee, and partner discounts apply to retakes as to first sittings.

VALIDITY AND RENEWAL

A credential lasts 12 months from the day it is earned. Renewing before it expires is free: an open-book, non-proctored assessment on Anthropic Partner Academy, retakable as often as needed, extending the credential another 12 months. Let it lapse and the full exam must be passed again at full fee.

APPEALS AND FAULTY QUESTIONS

Decisions can be appealed to Pearson within 14 days. Separately, anyone may report a question that looks wrong, ambiguous, or out of scope; reporting never counts against you, and a confirmed faulty item that affected a result is remedied with a free retake rather than a changed score.

Eligibility. Certification is currently open to people at Claude Partner Network organizations, registering with a recognised company email. Domain record changes take 7 to 10 days, so resolve any email problem well before you plan to sit.



The repository behind it

This booklet is a snapshot, printed on a date. The repository is the living version: maintained, link-checked every week, and updated when Anthropic changes the program. These are the things paper cannot do.

PRACTISE, NOT JUST READ

A bank of original practice questions with a shuffled, timed engine that runs in your browser or your terminal. It reorders questions and options on every run, so nothing can be memorised by position, and it scores you per domain the way the real report does.

STUDY THE WAY YOU ALREADY STUDY

A flashcard deck covering every fact, domain weight, rule, and term, in a format Anki, Quizlet, and RemNote all import directly. A progress tracker that weights each domain by its share of the exam, so the number tells you how much of the paper you can actually answer.

A COACH THAT KNOWS THE BLUEPRINT

Open the repository in Claude Code and six commands are waiting: run a diagnostic to find weak domains, drill one of them, sit a timed mock, build a study plan or a week of sessions, and interpret a real score report into a decision.

THE OFFICIAL DOCUMENTS, KEPT CURRENT

Every official exam guide and policy PDF, mirrored with its source URL and the date it was last checked, so you can verify anything here against the original in one click. A weekly job re-checks every link, and a script re-downloads the documents and reports what changed.

THE PARTS THAT GO STALE FASTEST

Fees, discounts, question counts, and the migration-era rules change. The repository carries dated facts and a maintenance routine designed to catch them. When something here disagrees with the official exam guide, the guide is right, and the repository is where the correction lands first.

OTHER CANDIDATES

A discussion space for preparation questions and exam experiences, under one firm rule: real exam content is never posted. If this booklet helped, the most useful thing you can do is answer someone else's question there.

Everything is free and open source. No account, no paywall, no email capture. Take it, use it, fork it, and send it to whoever is studying next.

github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS



Where to go next

THREE PLACES TO GO

github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS

The repository: practice engine, flashcards, progress tracker, and the mirrored official documents.

amey-thakur.github.io/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS

The same material as a searchable website, with the practice engine in the browser.

anthropic.skilljar.com

The official courses, free, without a partner account. Registration and the exams run through Anthropic Partner Academy and Pearson VUE.

IF THIS HELPED

Share it with whoever is studying next. Corrections are welcome as issues, and questions about preparation belong in the repository's discussions, where the one firm rule is that real exam content is never posted.

Whatever you are preparing for, the path is the same: read the blueprint, close the gaps honestly, build something real, and book the date. You do not need permission or a better moment.

— Amey Thakur

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